

Alohi Creator Business Strategy & Agency Renegotiation Handoff

Executive Summary

Alohi ("Lohi", @lohilohi) is a Seattle-based cosplay creator focused on anime, gaming, cosplay, dance, and fandom content.

Current situation:

- Employed full-time at approximately \$60,000/year
- Interested in transitioning to full-time content creation
- Currently represented by an agency
- Family is evaluating whether to renegotiate, replace, or eliminate agency representation

Primary objective:

Build a sustainable creator business that can eventually replace and exceed employment income while maintaining control of the brand.

Current Audience Snapshot

TikTok

Account: @lohilohi

Metrics:

- 1,000,000 followers
- 36.1 million total likes
- Typical content:
 - Anime cosplay
 - Dance videos
 - Skits
 - K-pop inspired content
 - Gaming fandom content

Performance:

- Regular videos: ~20K–90K views
- Strong performers: 100K–200K+ views
- Viral examples:

- Jujutsu Kaisen content
- Gojo/Geto themed videos
- Cosplay dances
- K-pop Demon Hunters content

Assessment:

- Strong platform
- Healthy reach
- Proven ability to go viral
- Primary monetization asset

Instagram

Account: @lohilohi

Metrics:

- ~177,000 followers
- ~153 posts

Performance:

- Typical likes:
- 1,500–3,600
- Typical comments:
- 10–20

Assessment:

- Visually strong
- Engagement relatively low compared to follower count
- Useful supporting platform for sponsorship packages

Strategic Assessment

Current Position

Alohi is not a small creator.

She sits in the:

"Large audience, under-monetized" category.

Strengths:

- Large TikTok audience
- Strong niche identity
- High-quality cosplay production
- Existing collaboration network
- Multiple fandom communities

Weaknesses:

- Revenue systems unclear
 - Potential overreliance on agency
 - Instagram engagement below ideal levels
 - Business development appears reactive instead of proactive
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Agency Evaluation Framework

Questions To Ask Current Agency

Deal Flow

How many deals are being sourced per month?

Desired answer:

- Consistent flow
- Clear pipeline
- Measurable targets

Red flags:

- Vague answers
 - "It depends"
 - No measurable goals
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Growth Strategy

Ask:

- How are they helping audience growth?
- How are they improving engagement?
- What is their creator roadmap?

Red flags:

- No strategy beyond responding to inbound emails
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Brand Positioning

Ask:

- What brands are they actively pitching?

Desired categories:

- Anime
 - Gaming
 - Apparel
 - Conventions
 - Collectibles
 - Streaming platforms
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Contract Terms

Desired structure:

- 20% commission maximum on agency-sourced deals
- 0–10% commission on creator-sourced deals
- 30–60 day exit clause
- Creator retains ownership of all IP

Avoid:

- Long exclusivity
 - Ownership claims
 - Commission on all revenue regardless of source
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Recommendation: Does Alohi Need An Agent?

Short Answer

No.

She does not currently require a traditional agent.

Better Answer

She needs:

- More deals
- Better pricing
- Revenue systems

An agent is only useful if they materially increase income beyond their commission.

Example:

If revenue is:

\$10,000/month

Agency commission:

20%

Cost:

\$2,000/month \$24,000/year

Question:

Are they generating more than \$24,000/year in additional value?

If not, they are a cost center rather than a growth partner.

Independent Creator Business Model

Goal

Operate as a media business rather than as a hobbyist creator.

Revenue System

Machine 1: Inbound Capture

All inquiries should route through:

business@domain.com

or

alohi@domain.com

Bio example:

Business inquiries: alohi@domain.com

Machine 2: Lead Qualification

Every brand receives:

"Thanks for reaching out.

Could you please share:

- Campaign goals
- Deliverables
- Timeline
- Budget range
- Usage rights requirements
- Paid advertising requirements

Looking forward to learning more."

Purpose:

- Filter low-quality leads
 - Establish professionalism
 - Force budget disclosure
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Machine 3: Pricing

Starting Rate Card

TikTok

- Single TikTok post:
- \$5,000

TikTok + Instagram

- Package:
- \$6,500–\$8,000

Usage Rights

- Add 30–100%

Exclusivity

- Add 20–50%

Guideline:

Never apologize for pricing.

State pricing confidently.

Machine 4: Negotiation

Rule:

Never immediately discount.

Instead:

Reduce scope.

Example:

If brand budget is low:

- Fewer deliverables
- Shorter usage period
- Single platform instead of bundle

Counteroffer strategy:

Brand offers: \$3,000

Counter: \$4,200

Meet in the middle rather than accepting initial offer.

Machine 5: Repeat Business

After successful campaigns:

Send follow-up.

Goal:

Convert one-time campaigns into:

- Retainers
 - Ambassador programs
 - Annual partnerships
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Outbound Brand Acquisition

Most creators wait for inbound.

Recommendation:

Actively pitch brands.

Weekly target:

25–50 outreach emails.

Target categories:

- Anime brands
 - Gaming companies
 - Apparel
 - Collectibles
 - Conventions
 - Streaming services
 - Figure manufacturers
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Simple Operations Stack

No expensive CRM needed.

Recommended:

Email:

- Gmail

Tracking:

- Google Sheets

Optional:

- Notion

Folders:

- New
- Negotiating
- Closed

Track:

- Brand
 - Contact
 - Offer
 - Final Amount
 - Status
 - Notes
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30-Day Execution Plan

Week 1

- Clean bios
 - Create business email
 - Build prospect list
 - Set up tracking system
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Week 2

- Begin outreach
 - Send 5–10 pitches daily
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Week 3

- Refine pricing
 - Track response rates
 - Start negotiations
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Week 4

- Analyze results
 - Adjust pricing
 - Build repeat partnerships
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Long-Term Revenue Expansion

Beyond sponsorships:

Memberships

Potential:

- Patreon
 - Membership communities
 - Exclusive cosplay content
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Digital Products

Potential:

- Cosplay guides
 - Tutorials
 - Presets
 - Downloadable resources
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Events

Potential:

- Convention appearances
- Panels

- Meet-and-greets
 - Workshops
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Brand Ambassadorships

Goal:

Fewer campaigns.

Higher value.

Recurring revenue.

Final Strategic Conclusion

Current recommendation:

1. Renegotiate current agency relationship aggressively.
2. Avoid long-term exclusive agreements.
3. Build direct brand acquisition systems immediately.
4. Treat content creation as a media business.
5. Delay quitting full-time employment until creator income demonstrates consistency.
6. Focus on recurring sponsorships and long-term partnerships rather than one-off campaigns.

Core principle:

Alohi's largest opportunity is not audience growth.

It is monetization optimization.

The goal is to convert a large audience into a predictable, scalable business.